

Job Title/Position: *Palliative Care Medical Social Worker*

Reports To: *Clinical Supervisor or Masters of Social Work*

JOB DESCRIPTION SUMMARY

The palliative care medical social worker contracted or employed through the organization is responsible for the implementation of standards of care for medical social work services.

ESSENTIAL JOB FUNCTIONS/RESPONSIBILITIES

1. Assesses the psychosocial status of patients and families/caregivers related to the patient's life-limiting illness and environment and communicates findings to the palliative care registered nurse and other members of the interdisciplinary group. Provides an assessment in the patient's identified residence and assistance when this is not safe and another plan is required.
2. Carries out social evaluations and plans intervention based on evaluation findings. Counsels patient and family/caregivers as needed in relationship to stress, and other identified coping difficulties.
3. Provides information and education about advance care planning to the patient and family as appropriate.
4. Maintains clinical records on all patients referred to social work.
5. Provides information and referral services for organization patients and families/caregivers regarding practical and environmental needs.
6. Provides information to patients and families/caregivers and community agencies.
7. Serves as liaison between patients and families/caregivers and community agencies.
8. Maintains collaborative relationships with organization personnel to support palliative patient care.
9. Maintains and develops contacts with public and private agencies as resources for patient and personnel.
10. Participates in the development of the individualized plan of care and attends regularly scheduled interdisciplinary group meetings.
11. Assists physician and other team members in understanding significant social and emotional factors related to chronic health problems and death/dying issues.
12. Actively participates in quality assessment performance improvement teams and activities.
13. Other duties as delegated by the Clinical Supervisor.

The above statements are only meant to be a representative summary of the major duties and responsibilities performed by incumbents of this job. The incumbents may be requested to perform job related tasks other than those stated in this description.

POSITION QUALIFICATIONS

1. A graduate of a bachelor's program in social work accredited by the Council on Social Work Education.
2. Minimum of one year's experience in health care, home care, hospice or palliative care experience preferred. Understands palliative care philosophy, and issues of chronic illness and death/dying.
3. Pediatrics: Must have experience and/or training in the developmental stages and needs of pediatric patients. Understands the unique psychosocial needs of pediatric patients and their caregivers.
4. Has training in palliative care and/or hospice care; experience in hospice or palliative care; or has, or is eligible for, palliative care certification.
5. Experience in palliative care or hospice preferred.
6. Demonstrates good verbal and written communication, and organization skills.
7. Possesses and maintains current CPR Certification as required by organizational policy.
8. Must be a licensed driver with an automobile that is insured in accordance with state or organization requirements and is in good working order.

Employee Signature

Date